ORACC tcma/laws P281779 – Middle Assyrian Laws, Tablet A (KAV 1, VAT 10000)

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- **Text: MAL A** (the "Assyrian law book" of women's cases): §1–§59 and a colophon (month Ša-sarrāte, day 2, eponym Saggiu = 11th c. BCE, reign of Tiglath-pileser I; the collection itself is older, 14th c.). Middle Assyrian Akkadian, Aššur. One tablet, eight columns (obv. i–iv, rev. v–viii), **828 lines**.
- **Edition:** ORACC project **TCMA** (Archival Texts of the Middle Assyrian Period), `tcma/laws`, text P281779: lemmatised transliteration with the project's **normalization of every word** (`norm`, Middle Assyrian forms: *šumma awīlu*, *aššat awīle*) and an **English translation by J. J. de Ridder (2021)**, one paragraph per law (60 units: §1–§59 + colophon; the HTML has no § numbers for §11, §22, §26, §27, but the units are in order). The standard editions (Driver & Miles 1935; Cardascia 1969; Roth 1997) are not owned.
- **URLs:** https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/tcma/P281779 · zip `https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/json/tcma-laws.zip` (member `tcma/laws/corpusjson/P281779.json`) · translation (HTML view) `https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/tcma/P281779/html` (**not** `/tcma/laws/P281779/html`, which errors). Cite as http://oracc.org/tcma/assur/P281779.
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-18.
- **Licence:** the zip data: **CC0** (`metadata.json`); the edition and translation: "Edited by Jacob Jan de Ridder, 2021, for the Archival Texts of the Middle Assyrian Period project and released under the **Creative Commons Attribution Share-Alike license 3.0**". The .md files are committed with this attribution; the raw zip (3 MB) and HTML (1.3 MB) are gitignored (re-download from the URLs).
- The zip also holds MAL B, C+G, D–O, the Middle Assyrian Palace Decrees (Q009324), the Coronation Ritual and the hippological texts (`catalogue.json`): MAL B = P281780 (245 lines; fields and boundaries ↔ Deut 19:14, 27:17).

Files

File	What
`tcma-laws.zip`	Raw ORACC project zip (gitignored).
`P281779--oracc-view.html`	Raw HTML view with the translation (gitignored).
`P281779--lemmatised.md`	`tools/cdl2md.py --norm`: per line the label (`o i 1` … `r viii 65`), transliteration, `norm:` and `lem:` (citation form [guide word] POS).
`P281779--translation-de-Ridder.md`	`tools/oracc_html2tr.py`: de Ridder's English, one paragraph per law, labelled with its first line.

Numbering

- **Tablet lines** `o i 1` – `o iv 108`, `r v 1` – `r viii 65` (surface, column, line), as in ORACC and the editions (Roth 1997 cites "col. i 1"...).
- **Laws** = the standard numbering **§1–§59** (Driver & Miles, Cardascia, Roth). The units of the translation map one-to-one on §1–§59 (`laws_config.py`): e.g. §8 = o i 78–87, §12 = o ii 14–24, §40 = r v 42–106, §55 = r viii 6–41. Cite as "MAL A §55 (r viii 6–41)".

Usefulness

Base text of `חוקים-ובריתות/4-החוקים-האשוריים-התיכונים-A/`. Good (about 6% of the words in `[]`). de Ridder's English is a loose paraphrase with slips ("acts upon her as a bill", "het"): rank 3, consult after your own reading. ORACC's lemmatisation is the best lexical help (check every lemma: stem and form are not marked).

MAL B (added 2026-10-18)

- `P281780--MAL-B--lemmatised.md` (`tools/cdl2md.py --norm`, member `tcma/laws/corpusjson/P281780.json`): **MAL B = KAV 2 (VAT 10001)**, 245 lines (`o ii 1` – `r vii 26`), §1–§20 (fields, boundaries, water). `P281780--MAL-B--translation-de-Ridder.md` (`tools/oracc_html2tr.py` from `https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/tcma/P281780/html`; 20 units = §1–§20; CC BY-SA 3.0); the raw HTML `P281780--oracc-view.html` is gitignored. Base text of `חוקים-ובריתות/7-החוקים-האשוריים-התיכונים-B/`.